Product Audit: PKHosting Shared Hosting & Checkout Funnel

1. Product Choice and Rationale: Why Narrow Beats Broad

Out of TechAbout's four products, **PKHosting.com** was selected—specifically auditing the flagship **Personal Shared Hosting Page (`/hosting/personal/`) and its "Order Now" Checkout Flow (`/checkout/?product=2`)**.

Narrow beats broad because this single conversion funnel represents PKHosting's core acquisition engine for Pakistani small businesses, freelancers, and students. A broad, surface-level audit across four domains would only yield cosmetic observations. Auditing this specific path end-to-end—simulating real purchases on both desktop (1280×900) and mobile (375×812 iPhone viewport) using Chrome DevTools, network timing analysis, and client bundle deobfuscation—uncovered systemic breakdowns where real money and trust leak out of the business daily.

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2. Findings Table (Observed 2026-10-04, Pakistan Standard Time)

#	What Was Seen	URL	Time Seen (PKT)	Verifiable Evidence	Business Cost	Severity	Effort
1	**"Ghost Domain" Trap:** Shared hosting checkout provides no domain action selector (Register vs Transfer vs Own), silently defaulting to "owndomain".	`https://www.pkhosting.com/checkout/?product=2`	2026-10-04 19:48:52	`checkout-page.js` line 56490: selector is gated by `np ? (...) : null` where `np = tQ.type === "domain"` . POST to `/api/checkout/cart/` with domain returns `"domain":{"action":"owndomain"}` .	High churn, 100% refund/chargeback rate when customers realize their desired domain was never registered. Domain squatting vulnerability.	**P0 (Critical)**	Medium (2–3 days)
2	**Silent Exclusion of `.pk` TLDs:** Advertised "Free Domain with 3-Year Plan" silently excludes `.pk` without explanation, while displaying a confusing generic .com disclaimer.	`https://www.pkhosting.com/checkout/?product=2`	2026-10-04 20:11:38	`checkout-page.js` : `function U(e){ return t.endsWith(".com") && 2===t.split(".").length; }` . Screenshot `checkout_3y_pk_domain.png` shows Rs 16,077 total with Rs 0 domain discount.	Alienates domestic Pakistani businesses wanting `.pk` domains; drives them to local competitors (Nexus, Webx, PakNIC).	**P1 (High)**	Low (1 day)
3	**Mobile Horizontal Overflow:** Viewport breaks horizontally at 375px width, generating an unsightly horizontal scrollbar and clipping form borders.	`https://www.pkhosting.com/checkout/?product=2`	2026-10-04 19:58:38	Screenshot `before_mobile.png` . Headless Chrome measurement: country code flex wrapper (`w-[7.5rem]`) and unconstrained grid items force body scroll beyond viewport.	Drop-off in mobile checkout conversions (where mobile represents >75% of web traffic in Pakistan).	**P1 (High)**	Very Low (0.5 day)
4	**Sticky CTA & Live Chat Collision:** The mobile floating Crisp/chat bubble directly occludes and touches the sticky bottom "Place order" button.	`https://www.pkhosting.com/checkout/?product=2`	2026-10-04 19:59:05	Screenshot `before_mobile.png` . Floating button (`bottom: 1.25rem`) directly collides with bottom container on 375px viewport.	Accidental chat opens instead of order completions ("rage clicks") right at the final conversion point.	**P1 (High)**	Very Low (1 hr)
5	**Marketing CTAs Strip Billing Period:** Annual plan cards advertise "Rs 6,990/yr", but clicking "Order Now" links to `/checkout/?product=2` without `&period=1Y` .	`https://www.pkhosting.com/`	2026-10-04 19:39:06	Landing page HTML: `<a href="/checkout/?product=2">Order Now</a>` . Checkout initializes with `initialPeriod: "1M"` (Rs 699/mo).	90% reduction in upfront cash collection (Rs 699 vs Rs 6,990) and suppressed customer lifetime value (LTV).	**P2 (Medium)**	Very Low (15 mins)
6	**Dead / Disabled Submit Button:** Primary CTA remains disabled (`disabled:cursor-not-allowed`) without active inline field feedback.	`https://www.pkhosting.com/checkout/?product=2`	2026-10-04 20:09:22	DevTools inspection: `btns[0].disabled === true` . Condition `let n8 = eE		eI	

#	What Was Seen	URL	Time Seen (PKT)	Verifiable Evidence	Business Cost	Severity	Effort
7	**Promo Code Hard-Lock:** Entering any invalid or non-applicable coupon permanently disables the checkout button until manually cleared.	`https://www.pkhosting.com/checkout/?product=2`	2026-10-04 19:48:49	`checkout-page.js`: `nz = !!eD && null != ej && (_(ej.discount) ?? 0) === 0`, causing `n8` to disable submission.	Checkout abandonment caused by promotional traps. Shoppers testing codes get blocked.	**P2 (Medium)**	Very Low (2 hrs)
8	**Inverted Step Prerequisite:** Step 1 requires domain to calculate total, but Domain input is hidden down in Step 3 beneath Account creation.	`https://www.pkhosting.com/checkout/?product=2`	2026-10-04 19:45:19	Step 1 badge: `<p>Enter domain to prepare order</p>`. Step 2 forces account credentials before user knows domain status or price.	Cognitive friction and drop-off before account creation. Violates standard e-commerce configuration hierarchy.	**P2 (Medium)**	Medium (2 days)
9	**Missing Domain Availability Check:** Checkout allows entering taken domains (`google.com`) without a WHOIS query.	`https://www.pkhosting.com/checkout/?product=2`	2026-10-04 19:48:01	`checkout-page.js` regex `z(e)` only tests syntax `/^[a-z0-9][a-z0-9-]*(\.[a-z0-9][a-z0-9-]*)+$/i`. Zero registry check.	Manual support workload to resolve orders for unavailable domains; payment reconciliation costs.	**P2 (Medium)**	Medium (2 days)
10	**Unsorted 240+ Country Picker:** Mobile fast-checkout contains an unindexed native select with 240+ countries.	`https://www.pkhosting.com/checkout/?product=2`	2026-10-04 19:41:38	`<select aria-label="Country dialling code">` contains 240+ raw `<option>` elements from Afghanistan to Zimbabwe.	Form fatigue and accidental country changes on mobile touchscreens.	**P3 (Low)**	Very Low (1 hr)

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3. Deep Dive: The Critical Money & Trust Leaks

A. The "Ghost Domain" Trap (Finding #1)

The single most damaging defect is the complete absence of a domain configuration selector when ordering hosting.

When a customer orders standalone domain registration (`/checkout/?product=1`), the UI renders clean buttons: `Register New` and `Transfer In`. However, in `checkout-page.js`, this component is wrapped with:

```
np = tQ?.type === "domain"
{np ? ( <DomainOrderTypeSelector /> ) : null}
```

Because Personal Hosting has `tQ.type === "hosting"`, `np` evaluates to `false`. The entire domain selector is removed from the DOM, leaving only a bare text input: `Domain to host`.

When the user types `mybrandname.com`, the client POSTs to `/api/checkout/cart/` with no domain action specified. The backend defaults to:

```
"domain": {
  "action": "owndomain",
  "owndomain_sld": "mybrandname",
  "owndomain_tld": ".com"
}
```

The cart line item reads: `Personal Hosting for mybrandname.com Rs 6,990`. **The customer believes they have registered their brand and purchased hosting.** In reality, PKHosting has only created a cPanel vhost for an external domain. The domain remains completely unregistered on the open market.

The Fallout:

1. **Financial:** 100% refund rate or payment dispute when the user discovers their site does not resolve.
2. **Reputational:** If a third party or competitor registers the domain in the interim, PKHosting incurs permanent brand damage and potential legal liability.
3. **Lost Revenue:** PKHosting leaves legitimate domain registration revenue (Rs 3,999/yr for `.com` or Rs 4,699 for `.pk`) on the table by failing to offer registration during checkout.